

Sinan Bolel

Director of Software Engineering

hi@sinanbolel.com | sinanbolel.com

linkedin.com/in/sinanbolel | github.com/sbolel

Software engineering leader with principal-level technical experience in secure cloud architecture, accessible web applications, and user experience. Builds engineering teams and delivery practices while remaining hands-on with architecture and implementation.

EXPERIENCE

Aquia Inc.

Director, Software Engineering

Jul 2025 - Present

- Scaled Aquia's software engineering practice from 7 to 15+ engineers in the first month through targeted hiring and mentoring.
- Own service delivery strategy and cloud architecture decisions for secure, maintainable government-client solutions.
- Established coaching and career growth paths for engineers and emerging leaders to support engagement and retention.
- Lead technical strategy for business proposals, contributing to contract wins and public-sector expansion opportunities.

Director, Frontend / UX / Design

Apr 2025 - Jul 2025

- Launched and scaled the Frontend, UX, and Design practice from zero to 5+ specialists in four months, establishing accessibility and human-centered design standards.
- Formalized collaboration across product, design, and engineering; mentored team leads in agile delivery and inclusive leadership.
- Guided a React 19 and Next.js 15 upgrade into production for a large state labor-benefits portal to improve performance and reliability.

Director, Software Engineering

Feb 2025 - Apr 2025

- Transitioned from principal engineer to lead Aquia's software engineering practice, growing headcount from 3 to 7 in 60 days.
- Authored engineering standards for coding, code review, and GitOps to establish shared code-quality baselines.

Principal Software Engineer

Apr 2022 - Feb 2025

- Architected and developed the SBOM Harbor frontend for governance teams to collect, manage, and analyze software bills of materials from SaaS vendors.
- Led development of a React and Material UI design system to support Section 508 accessibility requirements across internal applications.
- Designed a secure Salesforce integration across AWS GovCloud and commercial AWS APIs; led technical specifications, cost analysis, agency review, and delivery.
- Built Python tooling to automate engineering metrics reporting from GitHub and Jira; served as primary on-call engineer for releases, deployments, and incident triage.

CAPABILITIES & EDUCATION

Leadership: Engineering practice development, coaching, delivery strategy, architecture standards

Engineering: React, Next.js, JavaScript, Python, AWS, Google Cloud, CI/CD, GitOps, accessibility

Education: Northwestern University | Bachelor of Science | 2014

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Senior Software Engineer

May 2021 - Mar 2022

Chartbeat Inc.

- Led frontend architecture for Contempo, a content-planning and analytics subscription service; delivered UX features enabling the first 100 customer activations during alpha and beta.
- Replaced an outdated design system with Material UI, reducing the React application codebase by 50%.
- Published local development and build documentation to streamline onboarding for new project developers.
- Mentored 2 junior frontend developers in JavaScript, React, and Angular; reviewed 73% of the frontend team's pull requests.

Software Engineer

Jul 2020 - May 2021

Nissint Technologies

- Built internal web applications and reduced cloud operating costs by rearchitecting monolithic backends as serverless services.
- Designed user experiences for recruiting automation tools to improve workflow efficiency.

IT Programmer Analyst Lead, Sr. Data Analyst

Sep 2019 - Jul 2020

State of Maryland Department of Information Technology

- Implemented an Apptio technology business management solution and cross-functional procedures for collecting IT consumption data and improving cost transparency.
- Designed and implemented robotic process automation for financial data workflows to reduce manual processing.

Web Developer

Jun 2017 - Jul 2019

Bethesda Softworks

- Delivered Bethesda.net frontend features and fixes; migrated legacy JavaScript interfaces to React applications and built a library for coexistence with legacy services.
- Trained the UX team in React and established development standards and site reliability operating procedures.
- Resolved business-critical incidents as an on-call engineer during a global video game launch.

Senior Developer

Nov 2016 - Mar 2017

Green Key Technologies

- Built a VoIP calling and push-to-talk application; reduced bundle size from 10 MB to 1 MB and load time from 7 seconds to 700 ms through build optimization and CDN delivery.
- Implemented continuous delivery for Windows, macOS, Android, and iOS with CircleCI and AppVeyor; deployed a 15-node DC/OS Mesos cluster on Google Compute Engine.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Strike Social | Full Stack Software Engineer | Jul 2016 - Nov 2016

Rocket Wagon | Development Manager | Apr 2016 - Jul 2016

One Six Solutions | Consultant | Jan 2016 - Apr 2016

Pyro Platform | Co-founder | Dec 2014 - Aug 2015

Besso Labs | Co-founder | Jan 2014 - Dec 2014

Microsoft | Program Manager Intern | Jun 2013 - Sep 2013

SwipeSense, Inc. | Engineering Intern | Jun 2012 - May 2013

Northwestern University IT | Lead Consultant | Sep 2010 - Jan 2012

Northwestern University IT | Associate Consultant | Oct 2009 - Sep 2010

Freelance | Web Developer | Jan 2007 - Dec 2009